

Prof. Stuart Bowyer was born on August 2, 1934 and passed away on September 23, 2020 due to complications from COVID-19. In the 86 years between those dates, he invented the research field of Extreme Ultraviolet astronomy, started UC Berkeley's SETI program and recruited me into the field.

Many of you may have met Stu at different IAC Congresses, or the triennial Bioastronomy meetings. You will no doubt remember that he was bold and brash and larger than life! He never did things by half-measure, he threw himself completely into whatever he took on.

Stu was born and raised in Ohio. He received a degree in physics from Miami University of Ohio, and a then a Ph.D. from the Catholic University of America in Washington, DC. As a gradstudent he was part of a team that discovered the X-ray emitting source Cygnus X-1, the first black hole ever found. He continued to be involved in the early days of X-ray astronomy at the Naval Research Lab in Washington, and then Catholic University, arriving at UC Berkeley in 1968, the same year I entered grad school there. He was convinced that at wavelengths longer than X-rays, but shorter than visible UV there would be emission from hot objects filling the universe. His colleagues told him that any such radiation would be absorbed by hydrogen in the interstellar medium and the Earth's atmosphere. He persisted. Using balloons, sounding rockets, the Apollo-Soyuz mission, and finally a dedicated satellite called the Extreme Ultraviolet Explorer he proved them all wrong and established UC Berkeley as the powerhouse in EUV astronomy. Astonishingly he even convinced NASA to allow the Berkeley Center for EUV Astrophysics (that Stu directed) to take on the operational control of EUVE mission, something previously reserved for NASA centers.

Stu was intrigued by the 1971 Cyclops Report that emerged from a summer of ASEE studies at NASA Ames. With Mike Lampton, a colleague at the UC Space Sciences Lab, he conceived a way to do SETI observations commensally with the university's 85 Ft. radio telescope at the Hat Creek Radio Observatory. He recruited me because I knew how to program an obsolete PDP-8/S computer and a 100 channel PAR autocorrelator given to him by Prof. Jack Welch who ran HCRO. I contributed the acronym SERENDIP (Search for Extraterrestrial Radio Emission from Nearby Developed Intelligent Populations), and Stu gave birth to what would eventually become the Berkeley SETI Research Center, with a dynamic and robust search agenda funded by Breakthrough Listen.

Stu is survived by his wife Jane, his sons Bob and Bill and his daughter Beth, plus 5 grandchildren. He leaves a splendid legacy of two new fields of scientific exploration. I for one will miss the amazing parties the he and Jane used to host at their home in Orinda.